

Arte Merritt

Agentic AI & Conversational AI Leader · Founder · Keynote Speaker

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Two-time venture-backed founder (one exit to Nokia), 15+ years inside conversational and agentic AI, current operating role inside **Microsoft** after **AWS**. Career arc spans early mobile analytics, the chatbot & voice-AI wave, and the present **agentic-AI shift**. Frequent international keynote speaker (SXSW, Mobile World Congress, Voice Summit, World AI Cannes, AWS re:Invent, Microsoft Build). Author of *The Agentic Shift* (2026). Active angel investor. Building **Reconify**, observability for LLM applications.

EXPERIENCE

Agentic AI & Strategic Partnerships · Microsoft

April 2026 — Present

San Francisco Bay Area · Microsoft AI / Azure AI

- Building out Microsoft's **agentic-AI partner ecosystem** — Copilot Studio, Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, AI Agents — across ISVs and enterprise integrators.
- Strategy and go-to-market for **autonomous AI agents** on Microsoft's distribution surface: Microsoft 365, Teams, Copilot, and the Azure marketplace.
- Working surface: agent observability, multi-agent orchestration, tool use, function calling, MCP (Model Context Protocol), enterprise deployment of LLM-powered employees.

Head of Generative AI & Conversational AI Partners · Amazon Web Services (AWS)

2022 — 2025

San Francisco · AWS Marketplace · Generative AI Partners

- Led **generative AI** and **conversational AI** partner strategy across AWS Marketplace — sitting at the intersection where ISVs ship **LLM applications** on top of **Amazon Bedrock**, **SageMaker**, and the AWS AI stack.
- Created and ran **Built on Bedrock** demo nights at the AWS Builder Loft — the SF showcase for genAI builders working with Anthropic Claude, Amazon Titan, Meta Llama, Mistral, and other foundation models on Bedrock.
- Owned the partner relationship with leading conversational and agentic AI ISVs; built co-sell motions that brought multi-million-dollar AI deals through AWS field sales.
- Front-row seat to the commercialization curve of the foundation-model era — from GPT-3.5 era chatbots through the agentic shift.

Founder & CEO · Dashbot

2016 — 2022

San Francisco · Conversational-AI Analytics

- Founded and led **Dashbot** — the analytics and conversational-intelligence platform for chatbots, voice assistants, and conversational AI. Became the de-facto standard for **bot analytics**, **voice analytics**, and **NLU evaluation**.
- Scaled to **20,000+ customers** processing **90+ billion conversational messages** across enterprise voice and chat deployments — Google, T-Mobile, large financial-services and retail brands.
- Raised **\$15.6M** from Bessemer Venture Partners, ff Venture Capital, and a16z scout fund. Acquired strategic positioning in the conversational-AI space alongside Voiceflow, Cognigy, and Kore.ai.
- Industry recognition: **Gartner Cool Vendor 2018**, **MIT AI Idol 2018**, **Voicebot Top 11 People in Voice**. Quoted across TechCrunch, VentureBeat, The Information, Voicebot.ai.
- Created and ran **Superbot**, the annual conversational-and-agentic-AI conference; built the convening platform for the industry.

Founder · Motally (acquired by Nokia, 2010)

2008 — 2010

San Francisco · Mobile Analytics

- Founded one of the earliest **mobile-app analytics** platforms — instrumentation for native iOS, Android, BlackBerry, and Symbian apps before Mixpanel and Amplitude existed.
- **Acquired by Nokia in 2010** to power the analytics layer of the Symbian and MeeGo developer ecosystem.

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

Cambridge, MA

Engineering & computer science foundation. Active MIT alumni community in SF AI ecosystem.

SELECTED RECOGNITION & SPEAKING

- **Gartner Cool Vendor 2018** · **MIT AI Idol 2018** · **Voicebot Top 11 People in Voice**.
- Keynote / panel: **SXSW**, **Mobile World Congress**, **MobileBeat**, **Voice Summit**, **World AI Cannes**, **Project Voice**, **AWS re:Invent**, **Microsoft Build**, **Web Summit**, **VOICE Global**.
- Press & analyst coverage: TechCrunch, VentureBeat, The Information, Voicebot.ai, Forrester, Gartner.
- Author of *The Agentic Shift* (2026) — the working thesis on the move from chatbots to AI employees.

SIDE PROJECTS & ANGEL INVESTING

- **Reconify** — Building observability and analytics for generative-AI applications. The Dashbot of the LLM-application era: instrumentation, evaluation, and feedback loops for production AI agents.
- Active angel investor in conversational AI, agentic AI, voice AI, and developer-tools startups.

CORE COMPETENCIES & STACK

AI / ML Domains: Agentic AI, autonomous agents, conversational AI, voice AI, large language models (LLMs), foundation models, multi-agent systems, tool use, function calling, MCP, RAG, reasoning models, inference-time compute.

Frameworks & Platforms: Amazon Bedrock, Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, OpenAI API, Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, LangChain, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, Dialogflow, Lex, Rasa, Voiceflow.

GTM & Partnerships: Enterprise GenAI sales, ISV / partner ecosystem strategy, co-sell motions, marketplace go-to-market, developer-relations programs, analyst relations.

Founder Toolkit: Venture fundraising, board management, product strategy, executive hiring, M&A (Motally / Nokia), category creation.

Speaking & Thought Leadership: Keynote & panel, executive briefings, analyst & press relations, long-form writing on agentic and conversational AI.

Keywords: agentic AI, AI agents, autonomous agents, AI employees, multi-agent systems, conversational AI, voice AI, chatbot, bot analytics, voice analytics, LLM, large language model, foundation model, GPT, Claude, Gemini, Amazon Bedrock, Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry, Copilot Studio, Microsoft, AWS, Anthropic, OpenAI, Google DeepMind, generative AI, GenAI, ML, machine learning, NLU, NLP, RAG, retrieval augmented generation, tool use, function calling, MCP, Model Context Protocol, reasoning, planning, long-horizon planning, founder, CEO, co-founder, two-time founder, exit, acquisition, Nokia, Dashbot, Motally, Reconify, Bessemer Venture Partners, ff VC, a16z, partnerships, BD, business development, marketplace, ecosystem, ISV, partner, co-sell, GTM, go-to-market, enterprise AI, AI strategy, AI product, head of partnerships, head of generative AI, conversational AI lead, Gartner Cool Vendor, MIT AI Idol, Voicebot, Superbot, Built on Bedrock, SXSW, Voice Summit, Project Voice, World AI Cannes, MWC, Web Summit, keynote speaker, AI evangelist, AI thought leader, AI advisor, AI angel investor.